

Harrison B Goldspiel

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Education

University of Maine	Orono, ME
PhD Candidate, Ecology & Environmental Science	2021–Present
SUNY College of Environmental Science and Forestry	Syracuse, NY
MSc, Ecology	2016–2018
Brandeis University	Waltham, MA
BA, Environmental Studies	2009–2013

Peer-reviewed publications

10. Goldspiel, HB, Davis, S*, Winiarski, E*, Kubel, J, Grey, E, Charney, N. *Accepted*. Detection and succession properties of forested vernal pools with eDNA metabarcoding. *Ecological Solutions and Evidence*.
9. Goldspiel, HB, Charney, ND. 2026. *Ambystoma laterale-jeffersonianum* complex (Unisexual *Ambystoma*). Polydactyly. *Herp. Review*. 56.2: 175–176.
8. Goldspiel, HB, Hoffmann, KE, Charney, ND. 2025. Light at the end of the funnel: Taxonomic biases of trapping methods for studying wetland-breeding amphibians at variable depths. *Journal of Herpetology* 59.1: 1–10. <https://doi.org/10.1670/2460810>
7. Gould, E, Fraser, HS, Parker TH, Nakagawa, S, Griffith, SC, Veski, PA, Fidler, F, Hamilton DG, ... Goldspiel, HB, et al. 2025. Same data, different analysts: variation in effect sizes due to analytical decisions in ecology and evolutionary biology. *BMC Biol.* 23.35. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12915-024-02101-x>
6. Goldspiel, HB, Hoffmann, KE, Charney, ND. 2023. *Ambystoma laterale-jeffersonianum* complex (Unisexual *Ambystoma*). Longevity. *Herp. Review*. 54.4: 614–615.
5. Goldspiel, HB, Barr, B, Badding, J, Kuehn, D. 2023. Snapshots of nature-based recreation across large rural landscapes: Insights from geotagged photographs in the northeastern United States. *Environmental Management* 71.2: 234–248. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00267-022-01728-2>
4. Tapia, WA, Goldspiel, HB, Gibbs, JP. 2022. Introduction of giant tortoises as a replacement “ecosystem engineer” to facilitate restoration of Santa Fe Island, Galapagos. *Restoration Ecology* 30.1: e13476. <https://doi.org/10.1111/rec.13476>
3. Kuehn, D, Gibbs, JP, Goldspiel, HB, Barr, B, Sampson, A, Moutenot, M, Badding, J, Stradtman, L. 2020. Using social media data and park characteristics to understand park visitation. *Journal of Park and Recreation Administration*. <https://doi.org/10.18666/JPra-2019-10035>.
2. Goldspiel, HB, Cohen, JB, McGee GG, and Gibbs, JP. 2019. Forest land-use history affects outcomes of habitat augmentation for amphibian conservation. *Global Ecology and Conservation* 19: e00686. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gecco.2019.e00686>.
1. Goldspiel, HB, Newhouse, AE, Powell, WA, and Gibbs, JP. 2019. Effects of transgenic American chestnut leaf litter on growth and survival of wood frog larvae. *Restoration Ecology* 27.2: 371–378. <https://doi.org/10.1111/rec.12879>.

* undergraduate student

Book chapters

2. Tapia, WA, **Goldspiel, HB**, Sevilla, C, Málaga J, Gibbs, JP. 2021. Santa Fe Island: Return of Tortoises via a Replacement Species. In: Gibbs, JP, Cayot, L, Tapia, WA, editors. *Galapagos Tortoises, 1st Edition*. Academic Press, Cambridge, MA.
1. Gibbs, JP and **Goldspiel, HB**. 2021. Population Biology. In: Gibbs, JP, Cayot, L, Tapia, WA, editors. *Galapagos Tortoises, 1st Edition*. Academic Press, Cambridge, MA.

Reports

- Tapia, WA, **Goldspiel, HB**, Sevilla, C, and Gibbs, JP. 2021. Protocolo para Monitoreo Ecológico en la Isla Santa Fe, Galápagos. Galápagos Conservancy y Dirección del Parque Nacional Galápagos através de la Iniciativa para la Restauración de las Tortugas Gigantes Puerto Ayora, Galápagos, Ecuador. 28 Pages.
- Tapia, WA, **Goldspiel, HB**, Sevilla, C, and Gibbs, JP. 2019. Evaluación de la población de tortugas gigantes de la isla Española (*Chelonoidis hoodensis*) y la necesidad de mantener un programa de reproducción y crianza inicial en cautiverio. Report prepared for the Galapagos National Park Directorate. GTRI, Galapagos Conservancy. 47 Pages.
- Pérez-Juan, CM, **Goldspiel, HB**, Cuevas, J, and Tapia, WA. 2019. Estudio preliminar sobre la presencia y distribución de *Chelonoidis porteri* en las fincas de la zona sudeste colindantes al Parque Nacional Galápagos. Report prepared for the Galapagos National Park Directorate. GTRI, Galapagos Conservancy. 5 Pages.

Science writing

Edna and Al. 2025. *Spire: The Maine Journal of Conservation and Sustainability* Vol. 9.

Professional work experience

- Dept. of Wildlife, Fisheries, & Conservation Biology, UMaine** (<https://umaine.edu/wle/>) Orono, ME
Graduate Research / Teaching Assistant (20 hrs per week) Sep 2021–Present
- Developing novel monitoring techniques for cryptic species in forested wetlands
 - Studying distribution and habitat patterns of threatened salamanders in New England
 - Teaching students general field and data methods for terrestrial and aquatic ecosystems
- Environmental Design and Research** (<https://www.edrdpc.com/>) Syracuse, NY
Environmental Analyst (40 hrs per week) Apr–Aug 2021
- Performed wetland and stream delineations for renewable energy development projects
 - Wrote wildlife reports for permitting applications pursuant to Chapter XVIII (NYS ORES)
- Galapagos Conservancy** (www.galapagos.org) Galápagos, Ecuador
Biologist (40 hrs per week) Sep 2018–Jul 2020
- Designed and implemented ecological monitoring plans for threatened island species
 - Researched trends and interactions in tortoise populations, plant communities, and climate
- Department of Environmental and Forest Biology, SUNY-ESF** (www.esf.edu) Syracuse, NY
Research Assistant / Graduate Teaching Assistant (20–40 hrs per week) Jan 2016–Jun 2019
- Researched restoration strategies and outcomes for forest plants and wildlife
 - Investigated recreational and agricultural social-ecological-systems in USA and Siberia
 - Taught basic sampling and identification methods for plants, amphibians, and reptiles

Sierra Streams Institute (SSI) (www.sierrastreamsinstitute.org)

Nevada City, CA

AmeriCorps member, River Scientist (40 hrs per week)

Nov 2014–Oct 2015

- Monitored long-term ecological research sites in the northern Sierra Nevada foothills
- Organized and led community initiatives for ecological research, restoration, and education

Archbold Biological Station (www.archbold-station.org)

Venus, FL

Restoration Ecology & Herpetology Research Intern (40 hrs per week)

Mar–Oct 2014

- Monitored amphibian, reptile, and invertebrate populations in Florida scrub habitats
- Collected and managed data on wetland hydrology and biochemistry in seasonal ponds
- Investigated effects of fire management and feral hogs on wetland communities

Suburban Ecology Project, Brandeis University (www.brandeis.edu)

Waltham, MA

Research Intern in Forest Ecology and Management (20 hrs per week)

Jan–May 2013

- Surveyed plant and land cover profiles of long-term forest monitoring plots in Weston, MA
- Apprenticed on education-based maple sugar, firewood, and conservation programs

Teaching and mentoring experience

Teaching Assistant:

- Problem Solving in Conservation Biology (SUNY-ESF, Spring 2016)
- Dendrology (SUNY-ESF, Fall 2016, Fall 2017)
- Herpetology (SUNY-ESF, Spring 2017)
- Ecology Lab (UMaine, Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024)
- Wildlife Field Methods (UMaine, Summer 2025)

Instructor:

- Field Herpetology (one-day module) (SUNY-ESF, Summer 2016, Summer 2021)
- Conservation Biology (guest-lecturer) (UMaine, Spring 2022–2024)
- Animal Ecology and Conservation (guest-lecturer) (UC Santa Cruz, Fall 2025)

Mentored various undergraduate students in the field and lab, including:

- **SUNY-ESF:** Noah Garwood, Caden Richardson, Cassie Schlosser, Britton Conway, Alyssa Dugan, Allie Sholk, Monica Banghart, Alyssa Dugan, Vivan Steinbaugh, James Lee, Tim Bova
- **University of Maine:** Emma Winiarski, Lilia Membrino, Caroline Clemmer, Aidan Fogg, Alamea Banks, Ashton Groneman, Brendan Harris, Kiley Chen, Oluwadamilola Kolawole, Jaidyn Negley, Astrid Niles, Sarah Costa, Meaghan Erlebach

Invited talks

Goldspiel, HB. 2026. Exploring the Capacity of eDNA for Cryptic Salamanders and Vernal Pool Biodiversity. *Long Island Natural History Conference*, Stony Brook University.

Goldspiel, HB. 2025. Cryptic species and biodiversity in vernal pools: a view from Maine and Frog Pond. *Orono Land Trust*, Annual Members Meeting.

Goldspiel, HB. 2025. Exploring the capacity of eDNA for studying cryptic salamanders and vernal pool biodiversity in Maine. *Maine Association of Wetland Scientists*, Spring 2025 Meeting.

Goldspiel, HB. 2021. Restoring giants: conservation successes and challenges for island rewilding in Galápagos, Ecuador. *Department of Integrative Biology, University of Texas-Austin*.

Conference presentations

- Goldspiel, HB**, Kubel, JE, Grey, EK, Charney, ND. 2025. "Detection and Succession Properties of Vernal Pool Communities with eDNA Metabarcoding." Poster at Northeast Partners in Amphibian and Reptile Conservation, 10–12 August 2025, Dingmans Ferry, PA, USA. ***(best graduate poster)*
- Goldspiel, HB**, Kubel, JE, Grey, EK, Charney, ND. 2025. "Detection and Succession Properties of Vernal Pool Communities with eDNA Metabarcoding." Poster at Northeast Natural History Conservation, 4 – 6 April 2025, Springfield, MA, USA.
- Goldspiel, HB**, Kubel, JE, Grey, EK, Charney, ND, Blanco-Ortiz, P, Kaganer, A, Davis, S, Stoeckle, M. 2024. "Using eDNA to study unisexual *Ambystoma* dynamics across the northeastern US." Talk at Northeast Partners in Amphibian & Reptile Conservation, 28–30 July 2024, Winter Harbor, ME, USA.
- Goldspiel, HB**, Kubel, JE, Grey, EK, Charney, ND, Blanco-Ortiz, P, Kaganer, A, Davis, S, Stoeckle, M. 2024. "Using eDNA to study unisexual *Ambystoma* dynamics across landscapes." Talk at the unisexual *Ambystoma* symposium at Society for the Study of Amphibians & Reptiles, 26–30 June 2024, Ann Arbor, MI, USA.
- Goldspiel, HB**, Hoffmann, K, Charney, ND. 2023. "Deep-water funnel traps improve capture rates of cryptic salamanders in the *Ambystoma laterale* complex." Poster at Northeast Partners in Amphibian & Reptile Conservation, 25 July, 2023, Middletown, CT, USA.
- Goldspiel, HB**, Kubel, JE, Grey, EK, Charney, ND, Blanco-Ortiz, P, Kaganer, A, Davis, S, Stoeckle, M. 2023. "Disentangling a cryptic salamander complex with eDNA: a landscape assessment tool for the *Ambystoma laterale-jeffersonianum* complex." Talk at the Joint Meeting of Ichthyologists & Herpetologists, 15 July, 2023, Norfolk, VA, USA.
- Goldspiel, HB**, Kubel, JE, Grey, EK, Charney, ND. 2022. "Disentangling a cryptic salamander complex with eDNA: a landscape assessment tool for unisexual *Ambystoma* and their sperm-hosts." Poster at the Maine chapter of The Wildlife Society, Dec 2, 2022, Orono, ME, USA.
- Goldspiel, HB**, Kubel, JE, Grey, EK, Charney, ND. 2022. "Disentangling a cryptic salamander complex with eDNA: a landscape assessment tool for unisexual *Ambystoma* and their sperm-hosts." Poster at the Maine-eDNA Symposium, Dec 1, 2022, Orono, ME, USA.
- Goldspiel, HB**, Barr, B, Badding, J, and Kuehn, D. 2022. "Using crowdsourced photography and automated image classification to understand spatiotemporal patterns of nature-based recreation in the Northern Forest, USA." Talk at the North American Congress for Conservation Biology. July 19, 2022. Reno, NV, USA.
- Goldspiel, HB**, Tapia, WH, Cayot, LJ, Rueda, D, Sevilla, CS, Shoemaker, KT, and Gibbs, JP. 2020. "From near-extinction to recovery: conservation successes and challenges for the Española tortoise (*Chelonoidis hoodensis*) in Galápagos, Ecuador." Talk at the Latin American Congress for Conservation Biology. July 1–3, 2020. Virtual.
- Goldspiel, HB**, Nagel, LD, Schlesinger, MD, Waddell, J, Curatolo, J, and Gibbs, JP. 2019. "Long-term effects of landscape restoration on amphibian populations: Insights from a decade of monitoring constructed vernal pools in central New York." Talk at the New York State Wetlands Forum. April 2–3, 2019. Saratoga Springs, NY, USA.

Goldspiel, HB. 2017. "Spatial and historical drivers of pool-breeding amphibian occupancy in central New York." Poster at the Student Conference for Conservation Science. October 11–13, 2017. New York, NY, USA.

Goldspiel, HB. 2017. "Spatial and historical drivers of pool-breeding amphibian occupancy in central New York." Poster at the Joint Meeting of Ichthyologists & Herpetologists. July 12–16, 2017. Austin, TX, USA. *** (best poster in Ecology, Natural History, Distribution and Behavior)***

Honors and awards

Northeast Partners in Amphibian and Reptile Conservation

- Best Graduate Student Poster (Summer 2025)

University of Maine College of Earth, Life, and Health Sciences

- Graduate Service Award (Spring 2025)

University of Maine Graduate School

- Chase Distinguished Research Assistantship (Spring 2025) \$20,000

The Wildlife Society, Wetland Working Group

- Wetland Habitat and Research Scholarship (Fall 2024): \$500

Maine Association of Wetland Scientists

- Research Stipend (Spring 2024): \$2000

University of Maine Graduate Student Government

- Graduate Student Travel Grant (Spring 2023): \$421
- *Senator of the Year Award* (Spring 2023)

Chicago Herpetological Society

- Graduate Student Research Grant (Summer 2017): \$500

SUNY-College of Environmental Science and Forestry

- OIGS Travel Grant (Summer 2017): \$500
- GSA Travel & Research Grants (Summer 2017): \$1000

Norcross Wildlife Foundation

- Research Equipment Grant (Summer 2015): \$3000

Professional memberships

Northeast Partners in Amphibian and Reptile Conservation	2021–Present
The Wildlife Society	2020–Present
The Ecological Society of America	2017–Present
Society for Conservation Biology	2017–Present
Society for the Study of Amphibians and Reptiles	2016–Present

Service

Peer-review: *Ambio, Animal Conservation, Biological Journal of the Linnean Society, Ecological Indicators, Global Ecology & Conservation, Herpetological Conservation & Biology, Herpetological Review, Journal of Herpetology, Journal of Fish and Wildlife Management, Northeastern Naturalist, Western North American Naturalist*

Outreach:

- Maine Master Naturalist Program (visiting lecturer in Herpetology)
- Bangor Land Trust (lead vernal pool walks on BLT properties)

Northeast Partners in Amphibian and Reptile Conservation (NEPARC)

- Steering Committee (Nov 2024–Present)

University of Maine Department of Wildlife, Fisheries, and Conservation Biology

- Seminar Committee (Jan–Dec 2024)

University of Maine Graduate Student Government

- Senator (Jan 2023–July 2023)
- Liaison Officer (Nov 2023–Nov 2024)

University of Maine Graduate Workers Union–UAW

- Organizing Committee (Sept 2022–Present)
- Elections Committee (Sep 2023–Aug 2025)

Coding Club (Dept. Wildlife, Fisheries, and Conservation Biology, University of Maine)

- Facilitator and co-instructor, led workshops on data visualization and reproducibility (Fall 2022)

Data Science Workshop Series (Ecology and Environmental Sciences, University of Maine)

- Facilitator and co-instructor, led workshop on reproducibility and GitHub (Spring 2023)

Spire: The Maine Journal of Conservation and Sustainability

- Editor (Fall 2022–Spring 2025)
- Co-chief Editor (Summer 2025–Present)

Galapagos statsbeeRs (2019–2020)

- Co-founder of collaborative data science group for conservation partners in the Galapagos

Sierra Nevada AmeriCorps Partnership (2014–2015)

- AmeriCorps member; watershed science, education, and conservation

Other experience

Tutoring

- RStudio, Data Visualization, Statistics, Ecology

Bike & Build (www.bikeandbuild.org)

- Fundraised over \$4,600 and raised awareness about affordable housing issues in the US
- Rode from New Hampshire to Vancouver, BC (3767 mi.), with 30 other cyclists in 2013
- Facilitated discussions about affordable housing and bike safety in towns across the US

Additional skills and certifications

- Wilderness First Responder (July 2019–2022)
- CPR & First Aid (July 2019–2022, 2023–Present)
- Multi-day backpacking and backcountry trip planning (10+ years, 1000+ miles)
- Wetland/stream delineations (100+ hours)
- Software: RStudio, ArcGIS, QGIS, GitHub, MEGA, Geneious, Camelot, Microsoft Office
- Spanish proficient (10+ years)